

Algorithms

An algorithm is a set of instructions for performing a task. Some algorithms are more efficient than others and take less time or effort. Different types of algorithms can be used for simple tasks such as sorting a list of numbers.

Insertion sort

Imagine you've been given your class's exam papers to put in order from the lowest to the highest mark. "Insertion sort" creates a sorted section at the top of the pile and then inserts each unsorted paper into the correct position.

▽ How it works

"Insertion sort" goes through each of these stages sorting the numbers far quicker than a human could.

6 is sorted into position 1

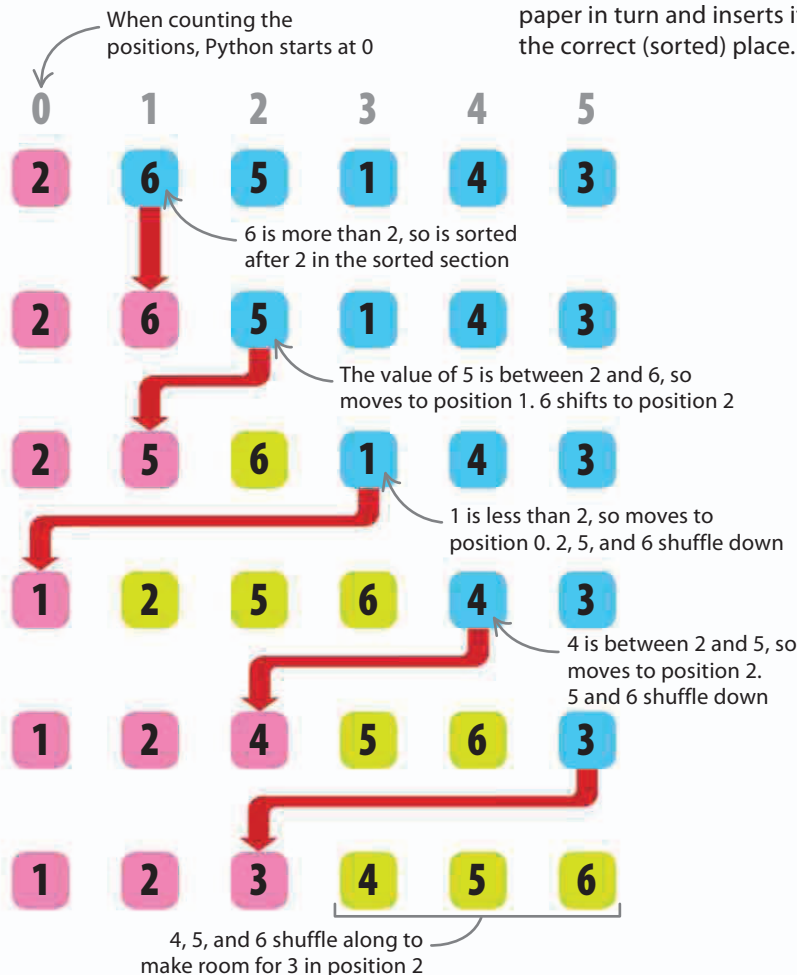
5 is sorted into position 1

1 is sorted into position 0

4 is sorted into position 2

3 is sorted into position 2

Sorted!



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△ Sorting in order

"Insertion sort" takes each paper in turn and inserts it into the correct (sorted) place.